

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

# The Complete Caro-Kann Defense

Reliable development, structure, theory, and active defense from Black's side

TRAINING WORKBOOK

30 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

# Workbook Method

Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

## REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

# 01. Advance Short System



## 02 - Advance Variation

### POSITION PROMPT

Black develops the light bishop outside the chain before attacking d4 and e5.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nf3 e6 5. Be2 c5 6. O-O Nc6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 02. Advance Tal 4.h4



02 - Advance Variation

POSITION PROMPT

White attacks the f5-bishop immediately and gains kingside space while Black fixes h4 with ...h5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. h4 h5 5. Bd3 Bxd3 6. Qxd3 e6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 03. Advance 4.Nc3



02 - Advance Variation

POSITION PROMPT

White gains tempi on the bishop with g4 while delaying kingside safety.

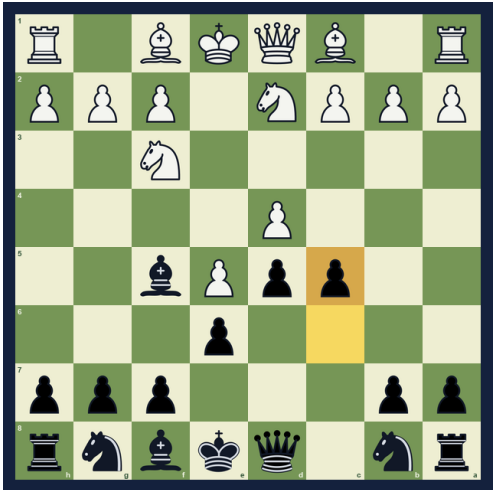
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nc3 e6 5. g4 Bg6 6. Nge2

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 04. Advance 4.Nd2



02 - Advance Variation

POSITION PROMPT

White develops without committing the c-pawn and prepares flexible kingside support.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nd2 e6 5. Ngf3 c5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 05. Botvinnik-Carls 3...c5



02 - Advance Variation

POSITION PROMPT

Black attacks the advanced center immediately and is willing to recover c5 through development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. dxc5 e6 5. Be3 Nd7 6. Nf3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 06. Advance Bayonet Restraint



02 - Advance Variation

POSITION PROMPT

Black chooses ...h6 rather than ...h5 and prepares a retreat while keeping the kingside less fixed.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. h4 h6 5. Bd3 Bxd3 6. Qxd3 e6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 07. Classical Main Position



03 - Classical 4...Bf5

POSITION PROMPT

Black trades the central pawns, develops the bishop, and accepts modest space for a sound structure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. h4 h6 7. Nf3 Nd7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 08. Classical 7.h5



03 - Classical 4...Bf5

POSITION PROMPT

White gains space and fixes the bishop on h7 while Black completes development behind it.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. h4 h6 7. Nf3 Nd7 8. h5 Bh7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 09. Classical 7.N1e2



03 - Classical 4...Bf5

POSITION PROMPT

White keeps the g1-knight flexible and prepares h5 or Nf4 without blocking the f-pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. N1e2 e6 7. h4 h6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 10. Classical Long Castling



03 - Classical 4...Bf5

POSITION PROMPT

White castles long and converts a quiet structure into opposite-wing play.

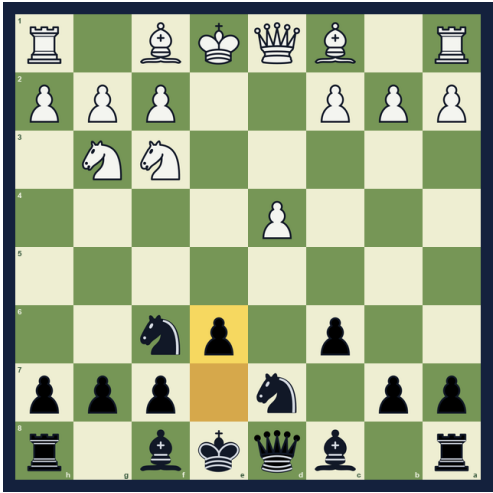
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. h4 h6 7. Nf3 Nd7 8. h5 Bh7 9. Bd3 Bxd3 10. Qxd3 e6 11. Bd2 Ngf6 12. O-O-O

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 11. Karpov 4...Nd7



04 - Karpov and Modern Systems

POSITION PROMPT

Black keeps the light bishop at home and develops solidly without allowing h4-h5 tempi against it.

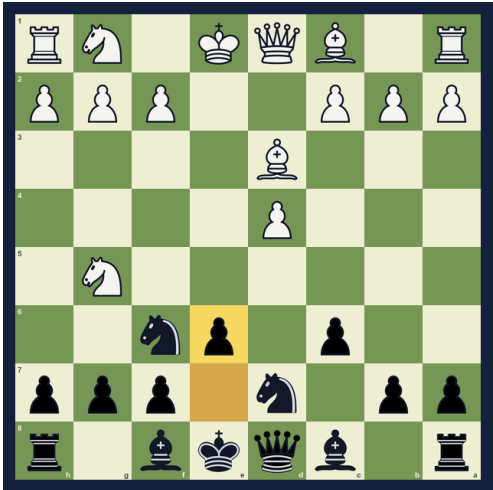
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Nd7 5. Nf3 Ngf6 6. Ng3 e6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 12. Karpov 5.Ng5



04 - Karpov and Modern Systems

POSITION PROMPT

White targets f7 early while Black relies on compact development and accurate defense.

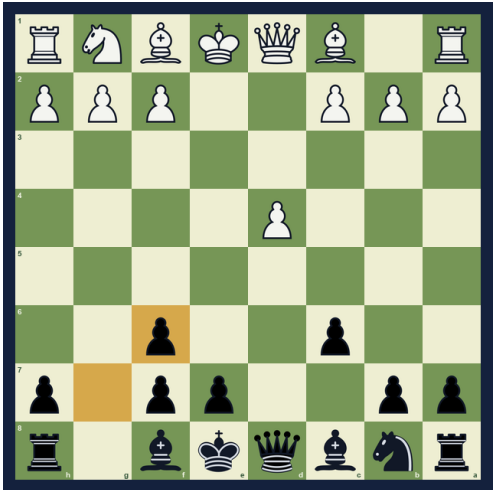
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Nd7 5. Ng5 Ngf6 6. Bd3 e6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 13. Bronstein-Larsen 4...Nf6



04 - Karpov and Modern Systems

POSITION PROMPT

Black accepts doubled f-pawns for the open g-file, bishop pair, and a dynamic center.

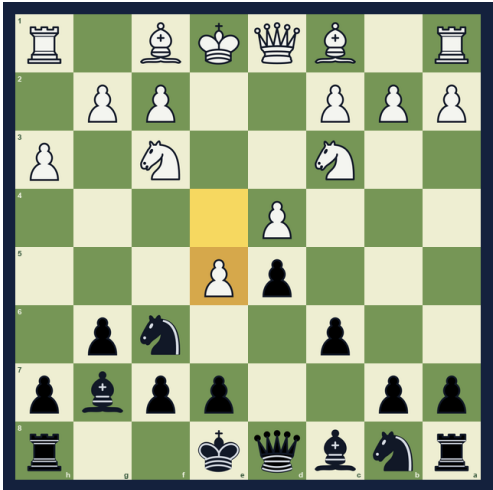
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Nf6 5. Nxf6+ gxf6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 14. Gurgenidze System



04 - Karpov and Modern Systems

POSITION PROMPT

Black fianchettoes and invites White to gain space before striking the center.

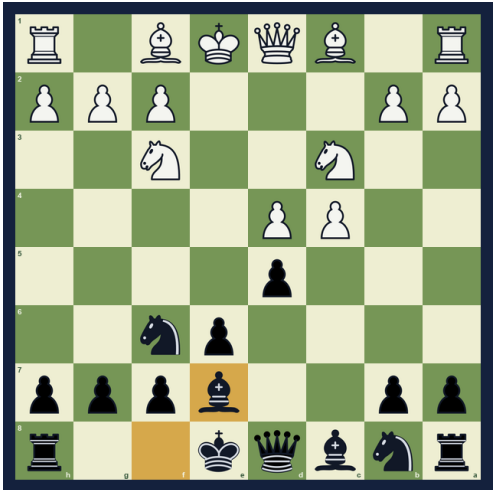
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. h3 Nf6 6. e5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 15. Panov Main Line



05 - Panov-Botvinnik

POSITION PROMPT

White accepts an isolated d-pawn structure for open lines and active piece development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6 6. Nf3 Be7

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 16. Panov 5...Nc6



05 - Panov-Botvinnik

POSITION PROMPT

Black develops actively and increases pressure on d4 while keeping the c8-bishop flexible.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Nf3 e6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  

---
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  

---
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  

---
4. Which piece has the least useful job?  

---
5. What ending would favor you, and why?  

---

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 17. Panov Fianchetto Defense



05 - Panov-Botvinnik

POSITION PROMPT

Black fianchettoes to pressure d4 and accepts an open center with an active dark bishop.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. cxd5 Nxd5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 18. Panov Endgame Structure



05 - Panov-Botvinnik

POSITION PROMPT

The center simplifies toward an IQP position where activity and blockade quality matter more than material.

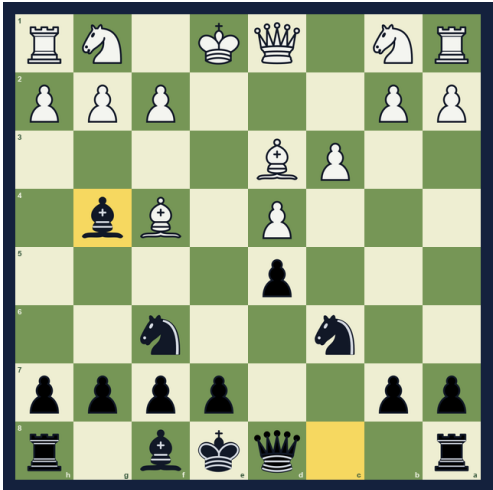
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6 6. Nf3 Be7 7. cxd5 Nxd5 8. Bd3 O-O 9. O-O Nc6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 19. Exchange 4.Bd3



06 - Exchange Variation

POSITION PROMPT

White builds a Carlsbad-style structure with active bishops while Black develops naturally against d4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. Bd3 Nc6 5. c3 Nf6 6. Bf4 Bg4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 20. Exchange 4.Nf3



06 - Exchange Variation

POSITION PROMPT

White develops quickly and keeps the c-pawn flexible while Black pins and pressures the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bd3 Nf6 6. O-O Bg4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 21. Exchange Minority Structure



06 - Exchange Variation

POSITION PROMPT

The symmetrical-looking center becomes a queenside minority and piece-activity battle.

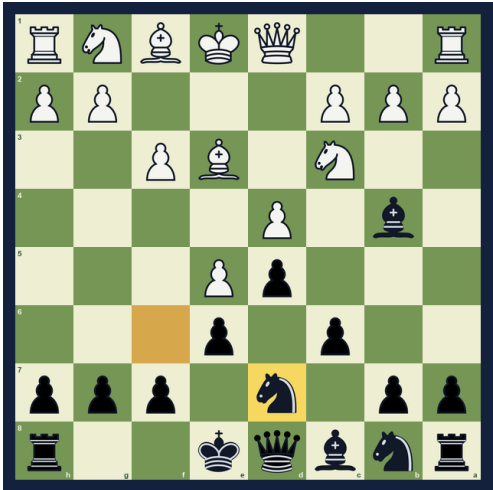
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. Bd3 Nc6 5. c3 Nf6 6. Bf4 Bg4 7. Qb3 Qd7 8. Nd2 e6 9. Ngf3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 22. Fantasy 3.f3 with ...e6



07 - Fantasy and Two Knights

POSITION PROMPT

White builds a large center and supports e4 with the f-pawn while Black attacks through development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. f3 e6 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. Be3 Bb4 6. e5 Nfd7

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  

---
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  

---
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  

---
4. Which piece has the least useful job?  

---
5. What ending would favor you, and why?  

---

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 23. Fantasy 3...Qb6



07 - Fantasy and Two Knights

POSITION PROMPT

Black pressures d4 and b2 immediately and offers dynamic central play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. f3 Qb6 4. Nc3 e5 5. dxe5 Bc5 6. Nh3

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 24. Two Knights 3...Bg4



07 - Fantasy and Two Knights

POSITION PROMPT

Black pins and exchanges a knight before establishing a solid center.

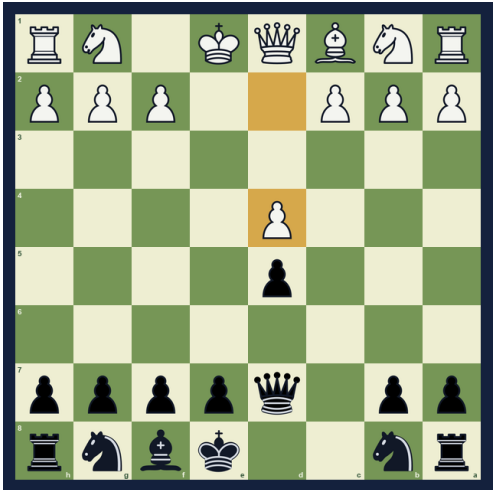
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. Nf3 d5 3. Nc3 Bg4 4. h3 Bxf3 5. Qxf3 e6 6. d4 Nf6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 25. Hillbilly Attack



## 08 - Sidelines and Repertoire Choices

### POSITION PROMPT

White develops the bishop aggressively before building the center, inviting Black to gain time with ...d5.

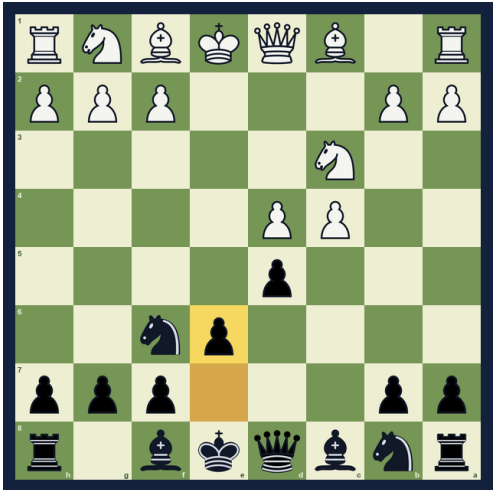
### REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. Bc4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. Bb5+ Bd7 5. Bxd7+ Qxd7 6. d4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 26. Accelerated Panov 2.c4



08 - Sidelines and Repertoire Choices

POSITION PROMPT

White reaches a Panov structure while keeping move-order options open.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. c4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 27. Breyer 2.d3



08 - Sidelines and Repertoire Choices

POSITION PROMPT

White avoids the main center and builds a restrained kingside setup while Black occupies e5 and d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ngf3 Bd6 5. g3 Nf6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 28. Apocalypse Attack



08 - Sidelines and Repertoire Choices

POSITION PROMPT

White centralizes the knight early and creates tactical pressure on f7 and b5.

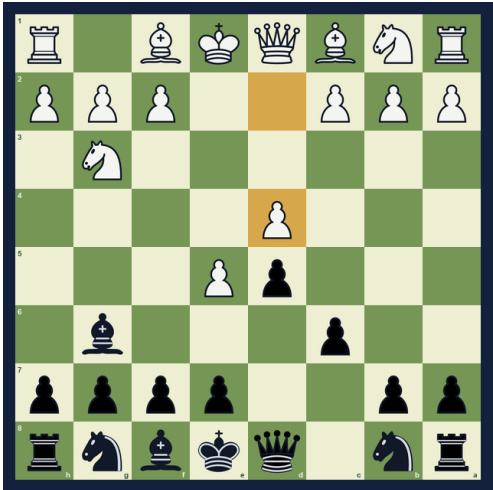
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. Nf3 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. Ne5 Nf6 5. d4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 29. 2.Ne2 System



08 - Sidelines and Repertoire Choices

POSITION PROMPT

White keeps both c- and f-pawns flexible and supports a delayed Advance structure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. Ne2 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Ng3 Bg6 5. d4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 30. 2.b3 Fianchetto



## 08 - Sidelines and Repertoire Choices

### POSITION PROMPT

White uses the b2-bishop to pressure e5 and g7 while Black occupies and defends the center.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. b3 d5 3. Bb2 dxe4 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. Qe2 Bf5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
- 
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
- 
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
- 
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
- 
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
- 

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.